Goals for 2016

PHOTOGRAPH BY MARK BAKER

Turning always forms a major part of my life and it is so much fun

Let me start by wishing you all a Happy New Year. This is typically a time for setting goals and personal challenges. For some it can be a springboard for change. In 2014 I set myself the challenge of turning 365 finished items during the year, you can read more about that on my blog posted on www.woodworkersinstitute.com on 23 December 2014.

This personal challenge attracted a lot of attention and many people enquired as to my progress and set their own turning challenges for the year. I didn't really set one for 2015, other than getting more family time, although that didn't work as well as I had hoped.

This year I have pondered what to do and have been looking at what is scheduled for 2016 and have decided not to tackle anything of the magnitude of the 2014 challenge. My decision this year is to spend more time with the family and, no doubt much to the relief of my wife, catch up on all the jobs around the house. I know that time at home is precious and my working away from home and also being away at demos and shows bites into family time. Before any rumours start, I am not cutting down on shows and demos, but, my 'spare time' will be better, or should I say, more rigorously monitored so as not to let the extraneous stuff get in the way. The items that are the worst offenders are the "… we just need, can you do, will you be free for this..?" type of thing.

I know I can fit everything in so it just needs me to be more diligent and prioritise a bit better. My wife reads the magazine so no doubt she will chuckle and think time will tell if this resolution comes about. I guess the ball is in my court.

Everyone has to work out what their priorities are and how best to manage everything. It isn't easy. Having said all of the above I need also to make sure that I get enough workshop time, which is something that many struggle to find time to do. I know it is frustrating, but in order to improve or develop work, one has to put in the time. I have designs I want to work with and see where they end up. So I will get workshop time, but the redecoration of the dining room, repair of my workshop door frame, the repainting of the garage door, the new patio door and whatever else has built up on the to do list must be done and that is my challenge for now. I also have a book to revise and a new one is being planned too. If I am good and get these done I might also be able to go fishing!

Let me know what resolutions and challenges you have set for this year. And remember to try to have lots of fun turning!

Best wishes,
Mark

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